

Spanish A1 — Week 3 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 3

Theme: Regular Verbs and Daily Routine

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 3 introduces the most important grammar pattern in Spanish: the regular *-ar* verb.

Most common Spanish verbs follow one of three patterns. This week you will learn the most common one — *-ar* — and use it to talk about your everyday life. You will also learn the single easiest negation in any language you have studied: just put *no* before the verb.

By the end of Week 3, you will be able to describe your daily routine in Spanish.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 3

By the end of Session 6, you should be able to say something like:

Por la mañana, tomo un café y preparo el desayuno. Trabajo de nueve a cinco. Normalmente escucho podcasts en el trabajo. Por la noche, miramos una serie o a veces descanso. No trabajo nunca los domingos.

And describe someone else:

Mi compañero de trabajo se llama Marco. Trabaja en diseño. Habla inglés y un poco de italiano. Estudia fotografía en su tiempo libre. No descansa mucho — trabaja mucho.

The -ar Verb Pattern

Here it is in full for *hablar* (to speak):

Subject	Form
yo	hablo
tú	hablas
él / ella / usted	habla
nosotros/as	hablamos
vosotros/as	habláis
ellos / ellas / ustedes	hablan

The good news: Every form sounds different, so it is easier to hear the distinction than in French. The stress pattern helps: the stress falls on the stem (*HABLO, HABLAS, HABLA, haBLAmos, haBLÁis, HABLAN*).

Drop the subject pronoun when it is clear: *Trabajo en una oficina* (not *Yo trabajo en una oficina*). Spanish speakers drop the subject pronoun when the context is obvious — the verb ending tells you who is speaking.

Negation Is One Word

To make any -ar verb negative, put *no* directly before it:

- *Trabajo* → *No trabajo*.
- *Habla inglés* → *No habla inglés*.
- *Descansamos* → *No descansamos*.

There is no two-part structure, no *ne...pas*, no exceptions. Just *no* + verb.

With "**never**": *Nunca trabajo los domingos*. Or: *No trabajo nunca los domingos*. Both are correct.

One Thing That Surprises Students This Week

Spanish has three verb families (-ar, -er, -ir) and you are only learning one this week. The curriculum introduces -er and -ir verbs in Week 4. You may wonder why you cannot say "I eat" or "I live" yet — you will learn those verbs very soon, and the pattern will feel familiar.

For now, notice that *ser* and *estar* (which you already know) are *irregular* — they do not follow a predictable pattern. The -ar verbs you are learning this week are *regular* — they all behave the same way. Most new verbs you add from here forward will be regular.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 5 — before Session 6:

1. **Say the -ar endings from memory.** -o, -as, -a, -amos, -áis, -an. Say them ten times with *hablar* as your model. Then try *trabajar*.
2. **Write 5 sentences about yourself.** Use 5 different verbs. Include one negative.
3. **Say your sentences out loud.** Close your notes on the third try.

After Session 6 — before Session 7:

1. **Write your daily routine.** 5–6 sentences with sequencing words (*primero, luego, después, finalmente*) and time expressions (*por la mañana, a las + hour*).
 2. **Add frequency.** At least two sentences with a frequency word: *siempre, normalmente, a veces, nunca*.
 3. **Say it out loud.** Aim to deliver the whole routine without notes on your third try.
-

A Note on Ser and Estar

You will still use *ser* and *estar* every week — they do not disappear when you learn -ar verbs. In fact, Week 3 gives you more chances to practice the *ser/estar* distinction in natural sentences:

- *Soy profesora. Trabajo en una universidad.* (*ser* for identity; -ar verb for action)
- *Estoy cansada. No descanso mucho.* (*estar* for state; -ar verb for habit)

Your instructor will continue to correct *ser/estar* errors. Each correction reinforces both what you learned in Week 2 and the new pattern you are building in Week 3.

Vocabulary to Know Before Week 4

See the full list in your Week 3 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 7 are:

- All six -ar verb endings from memory
- The 8–10 core verbs in their *yo, tú, él/ella* forms at minimum
- Negation with *no* and with *nunca*
- 3 frequency expressions (*normalmente, a veces, nunca*) placed correctly in a sentence
- 3–4 sequencing words for routine narration (*primero, luego, después, finalmente*)

Crescere — Spanish A1 Week 3 / Questions? Contact your instructor.